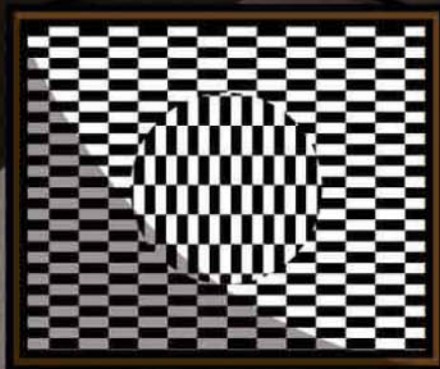


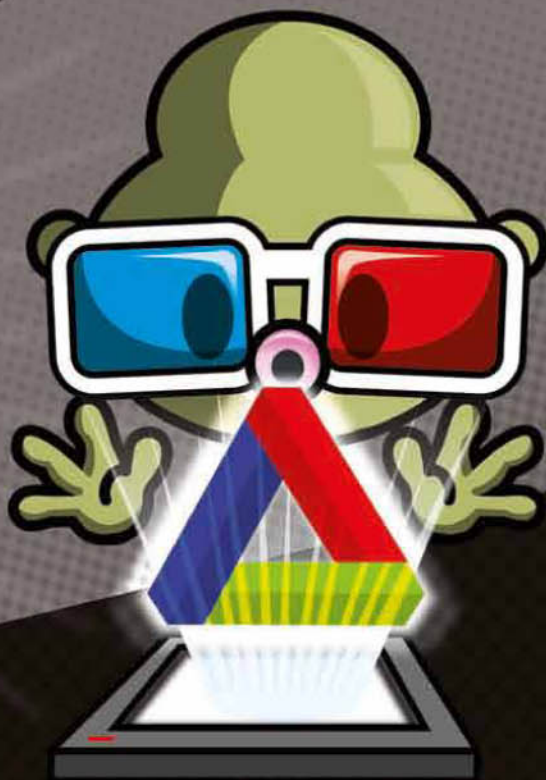
MOVING PATTERNS

Look at the eye-catching pattern on the right. The circle appears to be rotating, and the rectangles in the circle seem to float sideways. Don't worry, there's nothing wrong with your eyes—it's an optical illusion. The artist has used tricks of perspective (the positioning of the lines and curves in relation to one another) to fool the eyes into sending confusing signals to the brain.



DOUBLE VISION

Your two eyes send slightly different images to the brain, which automatically merges them together—this is how you judge distance. A three-dimensional (3-D) movie is projected in two different colors. When you wear special glasses, the red image enters one eye and the blue enters the other eye. Your brain puts them back together, so they appear 3-D.



FOOLING THE EYE

Artists and architects use a technique known as trompe l'oeil (French for "deceive the eye") to create lifelike 3-D effects. Fruit on a plate may look ready to eat, while a window painted on a wall appears to open up into a garden. The "impossible" triangle on the left seems to be a solid object, but look again . . .



OUT OF SHOT

The camera never lies, or so the saying goes. Yet, from the earliest days of photography, people have played around with images to make things seem other than they are. Russian dictator Joseph Stalin (1879–1953) was notorious for removing his political enemies from the scene by killing them off, before rubbing them out of photographs, too.

DOCTORED IMAGES

It happens more and more in the media today. Digital photographs are adapted in computer programs, such as Photoshop, to make celebrities appear thinner than they are or to put people in a location they shouldn't be. One famous Internet hoax showed a large shark snapping at a helicopter. It was made by combining two separate photographs. The trouble is you don't know what to believe anymore!



PECULIAR PERCEPTIONS

When you wake up and you perceive something or someone that isn't really there, you are probably having a hallucination. These can be momentary impressions of shapes or patterns or vivid sensations that last longer. Often strange and surreal, the experience is usually caused by high fever, a migraine, a food allergy, extreme fatigue, or certain drugs.